

mark items just like in a browser, view recently played and most-played items, and so on. (Winamp keeps a track of what you've been playing!) At the top, you can search for items in the library. Here, explore the "Metadata reading settings," even though it's been reported to be buggy (as of now). This is a button at the bottom of the Watch Folders tab. Metadata is added to files by certain programs, for example iTunes, and is basically information about the file such as album and length and so on. Once you press Configure, the options are self-explanatory—you can, for example, choose to "smartly" detect metadata such as track number, artist and title. This is useful when you have too large a music collection, and don't want to go through each song and manually look at what it is. So if you've synched with someone else's iPod (yes, you can sync devices to Winamp), it can display song information you haven't even entered.

Talking about song information, when a song in the playlist is in focus, pressing [Alt] + [3] takes you to the ID3 tag information window for the song. If you downloaded a song, you'll probably see information about the song here, such as artist, album, and so on. If you ripped a CD of yours, the information can be automatically entered here by your CD ripping program if you're connected to the Internet, and choose something like "Enter information from CDDb" in the ripping program. CDDb is a database on the Internet that holds information about almost all commercial CDs, and it'll seem like magic at first—all information about the songs in your CD comes is automatically entered into Winamp!

Of course, if you didn't use the CDDb option, or if a downloaded song doesn't have any information associated with it, you can manually enter the information in the fields in the ID3 tag window. It's a good idea to have your songs marked up this way, because they become easier to search through via the Media Library.

If you want songs to play continuously without a gap, here's a way: go to Plugins > Output > DirectSound output (or waveOut, as